

PUTTING COMMUNITIES AT THE CENTRE OF THE ENERGY TRANSITION

Lessons from Ghana



Ghana's experience shows how local dialogue, community-led data use and youth engagement can help communities shape decisions on energy transition, livelihoods and local development.

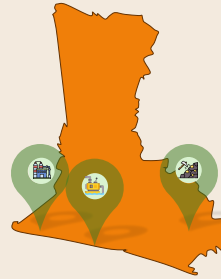
WHY?



Resource-dependent communities face **disproportionate impacts** from energy transition



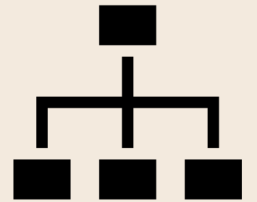
Communities historically **excluded from access to data, information & decision-making processes**



Ellembele District hosts critical gas infrastructure
(Ghana Gas, ENI facilities & Adamus Mines)



Local stakeholders **lack agency in national transition planning**



Structured participation mechanisms needed to ensure **just transition**

To create space for community voices in the energy transition and use EITI data to inform local planning and evidence-based decisions

Ellembelle Energy Transition Committee

12 Member Committee with Strategic Selection

25%
**Government
Agencies**

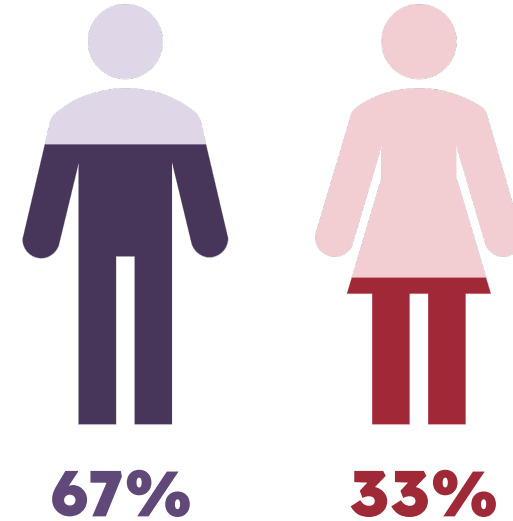
25%
**Media
Reps**

25%
**Extractive
Company
Reps**

8%
**Community
Reps**

8%
**Traditional
Authorities**

8%
**Civil
Society**



Aiming for **diverse perspectives** to be considered in energy transition planning, creating a **strong foundation for inclusive and widespread dialogue and community ownership.**

Bespoke Communication Strategy for Ellembelle



1

Infographic Flyers

Simplified for communities with low interest and literacy

GHEITI data on jobs and revenues, energy transition concepts

2

Radio Shows

For the whole district, including older and non-literate listeners

6 live sessions in Nzema and Twi (local Ghanaian languages)

3

High School Quiz

For young people, who will live and lead through the transition

6 senior high schools · 300+ students



INFOGRAPHIC FLYERS

1

Started from what communities asked about

Phase 1 showed demand for data on jobs, company social spending and district revenues.

2

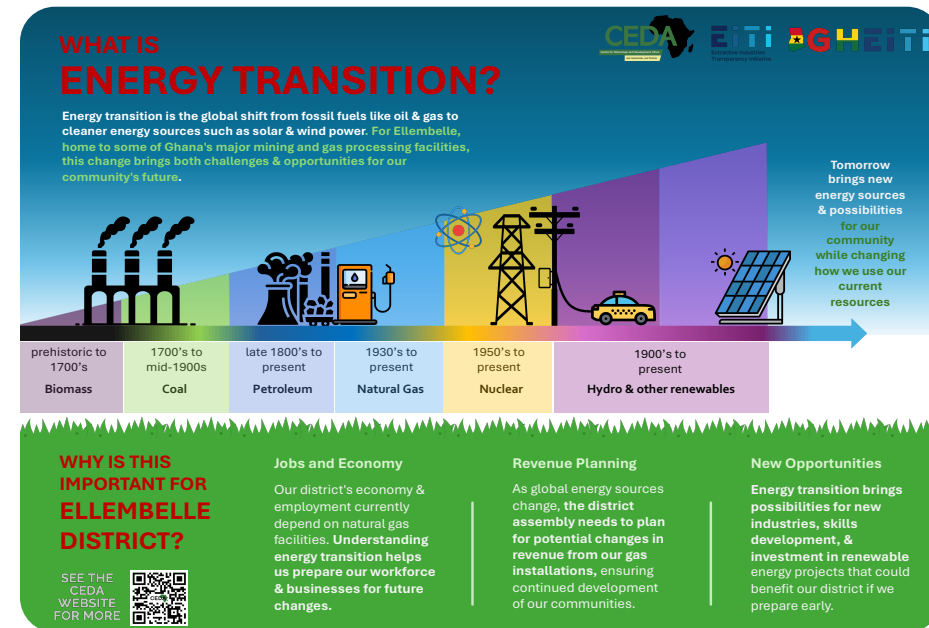
Turned GHEITI data into simple visuals

Local jobs at ENI's ORF, workforce age and gender, host-community share, and district royalties and ground rent.

3

Put the flyers in people's hands

Shared at town halls and outreach in Esiama, Sanzule, Aluku, Nkroful, Anwia and Teleku Bokazo, and on WhatsApp.



CEDA AND GHEITI SUPPORT

- **Designed and printed** a series of flyers built from EITI and GHEITI data.
- **Trained EETC members** in a Trainer-of-Trainers workshop (Feb 2025) to present data with the flyers.
- **Chose print on purpose**, so data reaches people without reliable internet.

WHAT CHANGED

Seeing the numbers helped people understand and relate to local issues; with flyers starting conversations during outreach sessions.



RADIO SHOWS

1

Trained local voices first

EETC members and local journalists learned about the transition, EITI data, public speaking and neutral framing.

2

Live on air on three local stations

Six sessions from April -June 2025, on Nzema FM and West End FM and New Day FM.

3

Spoke Nzema and Twi, and took calls

Listeners phoned in with questions; women leaders spoke as panellists and facilitators.



CEDA AND GHEITI SUPPORT

- **Ran the training** in Nov 2024 and Feb 2025 that prepared EETC members to lead the shows.
- **Taught ethical, neutral media practice:** objective framing and data linked to local examples.
- **Co-facilitated with GHEITI and the MSG** to give the sessions credibility and collect feedback.

WHAT CHANGED

Radio reached older people and those without formal education. Ghana's radio model has since informed EITI peer learning with Colombia and Indonesia.



HIGH SCHOOL QUIZ

1

The idea came from students

At school sessions for 500+ students, EETC members saw that young people needed a more engaging format.

2

Built with education partners

GHEITI and the GES District Education Directorate coordinated schools; Takoradi Technical University lecturer ran the quiz.

3

Three rounds, teams of three

General knowledge, then problem-solving on local cases, then rapid-fire questions using GHEITI data.



CEDA AND GHEITI SUPPORT

- **Co-led the quiz with the EETC**, from the first idea to the final round.
- **Brought in academic partners** so the questions were accurate and taken seriously.
- **Linked questions to local revenue data** and new green careers, so the transition felt relevant.
- **Information rich learning packets** developed for students' preparation

WHAT CHANGED

Parents, teachers and local media turned up, so the quiz reached the wider community too. The Education Directorate is open to making it an annual event.

Key Takeaways And Lessons Learned

DO's



Speak the local language

Nzema and Twi on radio, at town halls and in workshops made technical ideas easy to follow.



Train local messengers

EETC members are trusted, work in spaces relevant to the transition, and stay after the project ends.



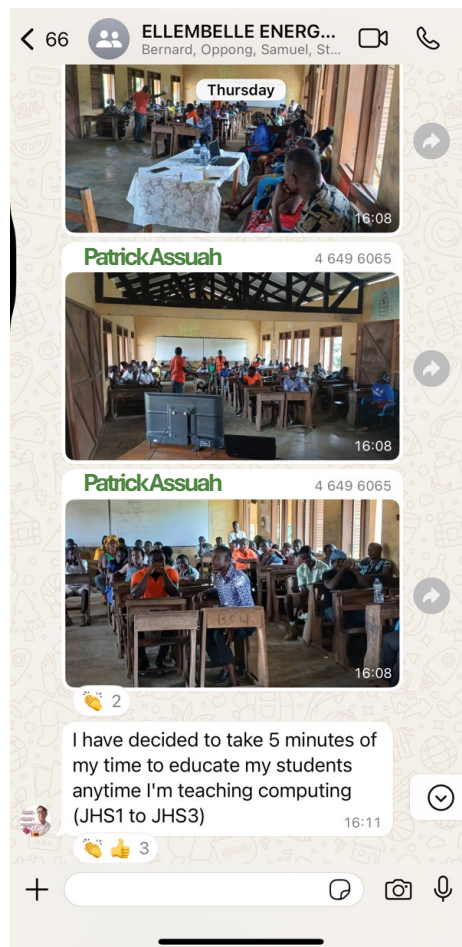
Put data on paper

Printed infographics reach people with poor internet access or low literacy.



Target young people

A school quiz run with Education Directorate engaged students and drew in their families.



DON'T's



Rely on digital channels alone

Connectivity is equally accessible; pair WhatsApp with print, radio and in-person sessions.



Hand people raw figures

Turn data into local stories, like jobs at the offshore receiving facility, or the royalties the district receives.



Take sides

Use neutral, fact-based language and show several perspectives to stay credible.



Assume support carries over

After the 2024 elections, new district officials had to be re-engaged to keep momentum.

**A partnership
between civil
society bridging
community trust
and credible data,
so that
transparency
reaches the people
it is meant to
serve.**

Deck Extract for Portfolio



**ACCESS PHOTOS,
VIDEOS & MORE
UPDATES FROM
EITI'S ENGAGING
COMMUNITIES IN A
JUST TRANSITION
IN GHANA!**